

Why Are Woke Christian Churches Obsessed With Drag Shows?

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When Grosvenor Park United Church in Saskatoon, Saskatchewan, announced it would host a ticketed "All Ages Drag Show" featuring performers dressed as DC comic book characters, it wasn't simply promoting another community event. Admission was set at \$10 for ages 12 and older, \$5 for children ages 5-11, while children four and under were admitted free.

For supporters, the event represented inclusion, diversity, and hospitality. For critics, it represented yet another example of a church embracing values increasingly at odds with historic Christian teaching.

But while the headlines focused on one congregation in one Canadian city, the bigger story reaches far beyond Saskatoon.

Over the past several years, a growing number of progressive churches throughout Canada, the United States, and Europe have hosted drag story hours, Pride worship services, drag brunches, and drag performances. This is no longer an isolated incident or an unusual experiment. It has become a recognizable pattern.

Which raises a more important question.

Why has drag become such a recurring symbol within progressive Christianity?

The answer isn't simply about entertainment or community outreach. It reflects a much deeper shift in how some churches understand Scripture, identity, and their mission in the modern world.

The drag show isn't really the story.

It's the symptom.

Drag Has Become More Than Entertainment

For most of history, churches sought to distinguish themselves from the surrounding culture. They cared for the poor, welcomed sinners, and proclaimed forgiveness through Christ, but they also believed they were called to be "set apart."

Today, many progressive churches appear to be pursuing a different goal: demonstrating cultural relevance.

That helps explain why drag has become such a powerful symbol.

Drag is no longer merely a form of theatrical entertainment. It has become a cultural statement about identity, gender, and self-expression. Hosting a drag event publicly communicates that a church has embraced contemporary views on these issues and wishes to be recognized for doing so.

Consider what receives the headlines today. Churches are rarely celebrated in secular media for holding prayer meetings, Bible studies, or evangelistic outreaches. But host a Pride event or an all-ages drag show, and national attention quickly follows.

That isn't accidental.

Drag has become one of the defining symbols of progressive culture, and increasingly, it has become one of the defining public symbols of progressive Christianity. It functions almost like a statement of allegiance--a way of declaring that traditional Christian understandings of sexuality and gender have been replaced by a newer vision centered on affirmation and self-expression.

The irony is striking. For two thousand years, the defining public symbols of Christianity have been the cross, baptism, communion, and the proclamation of the Gospel. Increasingly, however, some churches seem to gain the most public attention not for preaching Christ but for showcasing the latest cultural causes.

A Different Mission

Historically, the Church understood its mission in fairly straightforward terms.

Proclaim the Gospel.

Call people to repentance.

Make disciples.

Teach obedience to Christ.

Love sinners while pointing them toward transformation.

That mission assumed something fundamental: that every person--including every Christian--is being transformed into the likeness of Christ.

Many progressive churches increasingly begin with a different assumption.

Rather than asking, "How does Christ transform us?" the first question often becomes, "How can the church affirm people exactly as they understand themselves today?"

That subtle shift changes everything.

The emphasis moves from transformation to affirmation.

From repentance to validation.

From conforming our lives to Scripture to reinterpreting Scripture through the lens of modern identity.

Jesus welcomed sinners without reservation, but He never left them where they were. His grace always carried an invitation to repentance, renewal, and a new life. The Gospel was never merely an affirmation of our present identity; it was an invitation to become a new creation in Christ.

When affirmation replaces transformation as the church's central message, events like drag shows become far easier to justify--not because they represent the mission of historic Christianity, but because they reflect an entirely different understanding of what the church exists to accomplish.

Why Progressive Christianity Keeps Following Culture

Perhaps the most revealing question is this:

Why do progressive churches so often arrive at the same conclusions the surrounding culture reached first?

Twenty years ago, virtually no churches hosted drag performances.

The Bible has not changed.

The teachings of Christ have not changed.

Human nature has not changed.

Culture has.

As society's views on sexuality and gender shifted, some churches shifted with it. Tomorrow, if culture embraces new moral revolutions, history suggests these same churches may once again find themselves adapting in order to remain culturally relevant.

This pattern has repeated itself throughout church history.

Whenever the church seeks acceptance more than faithfulness, it becomes increasingly difficult to distinguish where Scripture ends and contemporary culture begins.

Ironically, the more a church mirrors the world, the less it has to offer the world.

If the church simply echoes society's latest moral consensus, why should anyone look to it for timeless truth?

People do not need the church to repeat what they already hear from universities, entertainment, social media, and politicians. They need the church to proclaim something eternal--something that does not rise and fall

with the latest cultural trend.

The Iceberg Beneath The Headlines

Most people focus on the visible controversy.

The drag show.

The Pride service.

The rainbow banners.

Those are merely the tip of the iceberg.

Beneath the surface lie far more significant theological changes.

It often begins with a diminished confidence in the authority of Scripture.

Once Scripture is no longer viewed as the final authority, difficult teachings become negotiable.

Sin is redefined.

Repentance becomes optional.

Affirmation becomes the highest virtue.

Personal identity becomes central.

Culture gradually becomes the teacher.

Eventually, practices that would once have been considered incompatible with historic Christian teaching no longer appear controversial within those communities. By the time a church hosts an all-ages drag show, the foundational theological changes have often been unfolding for years.

The event itself simply reveals where the church has already arrived.

This is why Christians should resist the temptation to become consumed by outrage over individual events. Those events are only the visible fruit. The roots lie much deeper--in how Scripture is interpreted, how sin is understood, and whether the church still believes God's Word has the authority to challenge every culture, including our own.

An Ancient Pattern In A Modern Form

The Bible records a recurring temptation for God's people.

Israel repeatedly adopted the beliefs and practices of surrounding nations, convinced they could blend devotion to God with the values of neighboring cultures. Whether it was the worship of Baal, the Asherah poles, or the customs of neighboring peoples, the issue was never merely the outward symbol.

The deeper issue was always the same.

Who was shaping Israel's worship?

God--or the surrounding culture?

Today's debates involve different issues, but they raise the same timeless question.

Who ultimately determines what the church believes?

Scripture?

Or the prevailing spirit of the age?

Every generation of Christians must answer that question. Every generation faces the temptation to soften uncomfortable truths in exchange for cultural acceptance.

More Than A Culture War

This discussion should not become an excuse for self-righteousness.

Every church faces cultural pressures.

Conservative churches can drift into political tribalism, celebrity culture, nationalism, consumerism, or elevating personalities above Christ. Progressive churches face different temptations.

The challenge is universal.

The issue is not whether the church engages culture--it must.

Jesus called His followers to be in the world, not of it.

The issue is whether the church is ultimately shaped by culture.

Christians are called to love every person with compassion, dignity, and grace because every human being bears the image of God. But genuine love also believes that God knows what leads to human flourishing better than any culture ever could.

Love without truth becomes sentimentality.

Truth without love becomes harshness.

Biblical Christianity has always insisted that both belong together.

The Real Question

Viewed in isolation, the event at Grosvenor Park United Church may appear to be simply another local controversy.

Viewed within the broader theological and cultural shifts reshaping parts of the modern church, however, it becomes something much more significant.

Drag shows will eventually fade from the headlines.

Another controversy will replace them.

But the deeper issue will remain.

Who has the authority to define truth?

If Scripture remains the church's final authority, then the church will inevitably find itself at odds with the culture at times, just as it has throughout history.

But if cultural approval becomes the highest priority, then every new social revolution will eventually find its way into the sanctuary.

The real question is not why one church in Saskatoon hosted a drag show.

The real question is why an increasing number of churches now believe such events faithfully express the mission of the church.

That conversation reaches far beyond one congregation or one denomination.

It goes to the very heart of whether the church exists to reflect Christ to the world--or to reflect the world back to itself.

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